

Android apps with Intel IPP

This article gives an introduction on how to add Intel IPP functions into Android NDK applications.



Twice as grand?

Samsung is set to launch its Galaxy Grand 2 smartphone in India soon. To find out more, check the link below <http://dgit.in/1jz2bH7>

Feature

media messages, online advertising and other online stimulants. The ability for the mind to focus diminishes with longer exposure making us a slave to the dopamine (pleasurable neurotransmitter) excitement received every time we see an alert seeking our attention. In essence making us addicted. Are we the masters or the puppets?

And as Google registers our location via our phone or profile information it presents results it considers relevant to us. That makes our life more convenient. When we're looking to shop online, websites like Amazon process our past buying behaviour and present us with options suited to our tastes. That makes our decisions faster. At every step technology steps in to save us time and energy. And we love it.

The cycle of rationalisation is complete. We're not addicted, we just need it.

Puppets to our own system

The world as we know it is now wired to work with us on the grid. Technology in all its forms is leveraged in visible and invisible ways to make life easier, faster, more productive and far more appealing online. Even if it is at the cost of safety and privacy.

Case in point: a network failure can collapse an entire power grid for millions of people (Northeast Blackout of 2003 in the United States), a software glitch can get people killed (South African robotic cannon accident of 2007) and social media websites can track and leak personal data (Facebook "shadow profile" leak of 2012) but aren't these just occasional accidents in an otherwise upward trajectory of progress? Maybe.

The advent of electricity was followed by a generation filled with the intellectual battle between Edison and Tesla, which eventually gave birth to modern power. And even the computer age saw its detractors, who doubted if there was even a market for personal computers. We shifted technology from an intellectual exercise with commercial benefits into a purely commercial one – with the belief that consumers would pick that which



Humans? Nah! Not a chance. We are nothing but a blob of flesh in suspended animation.

served the highest utility. Perhaps naively forgetting that adage that holds true above all else on the internet – an individual is smart and intelligent, but people are dumb as a sack of doorknobs.

Understanding our own monster

As has been true in history, a handful of people have often times created the most tectonic of shifts in human history, while the rest have benefited off it without realising the significance of the discoveries. How many of us can clearly explain how fire functions? Or explain the basic theory

of electricity? Or even the difference between a UNIX kernel and a Microsoft's hybrid kernel?

These fundamental cornerstones of our day to day existence still escape simple understanding among the general public. And it is the taste and preferences of the general public that technology companies rely on to lead technological innovation! Carl Sagan once said, "We live in a society exquisitely dependent on science and technology, in which hardly anyone knows anything about science and technology." This statement has never been truer.

In addition to this ignorance we are overwhelmed with the avalanche of information that is out there. Companies like Google tell us that they are working to make our online existence easier by organising and curating all this information using algorithms. These algorithms as we know run on computational mathematics applied to a vast number of data points in real time to connect us with the right content. In other words, doing our thinking for us.

Filter bubble: Escaping the gilded cage

Most users don't even consider the vast amounts of information hidden from them as they navigate the web using Google. Attempting other search engines (try DuckDuckGo) can give us a shocking and uncomfortable insight regarding the

